near being over.

Dave Seaman got up and carried on. The treatment had taken a while. If we'd played straight through, we'd have been in the dressing room by the time Brazil equalized. As it was, we were just waiting for the whistle. I remember the ball coming towards me on the touchline, just inside their half. It was from a Brazilian player who'd been looking to pass to Roberto Carlos but hit it with his shin. I was sure it was going out for an England throw which, seconds from half-time, would have been better for us than having the ball in open play. By the time Danny Mills had come forward to take it, the 45 would have been up. Roberto Carlos slid in with a tackle. I jumped in the air to let his momentum take the ball over the touchline, for our throw. Somehow, Carlos got a foot round it to keep it in play. And I was out of the game. They broke from halfway, played round Scholesy's challenge and got it to Ronaldhino twenty yards outside our penalty area. He had a trick to throw Ashley Cole off balance. He ran at Rio and then played a pass to his right to Rivaldo. In his stride, with no backlift, Rivaldo took the shot so early that Dave Seaman and the covering defenders didn't have a chance to get in the way. It couldn't have been a worse time for us to let in a goal.

Instead of going back into the cool of the dressing room on a high, with a lead to defend or to build on, the momentum had been snatched away from us. The looks on the England players' faces said it all. *We're exhausted. We've got nothing left.*

It was the story of our World Cup. We played our best soccer in the first half of games and then ran out of steam after half-time. I'm not sure how much was physical and how much was mental. I do know Rivaldo's goal killed us in Shizuoka. And I don't think there's anything that could have been said or done in the break to change that. Sven went round talking to players whose shoulders were sagging, whose heads were down. When he spoke to the whole team, he went straight to the point:

'We've played well. We should be winning 1–0. We've got to tidy things up, make sure we don't give away silly goals, and then we'll get our chance.'

Sven's never been a shouter, a manager to jump up and down. He may not be passionate in the way of an Alex Ferguson or a Martin O'Neill, but he's just as single-minded about winning matches as they are. Sven's passion and intensity come through in a different way. He's not about frightening players or shaking them up. He's about inspiring them, giving them confidence, making them desperate to play. His approach has worked for him throughout